

Rainbow's End

A NOVEL

By REX BEACH

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CHAPTER XXI.

Three Travelers Come Home.

Esteban Varona made slow progress toward recovery. In the weeks following O'Reilly's departure from Cubitas his gain was steady, but beyond a certain point he seemed unable to go. Then he began to lose strength. Esteban awoke to the fact that he was losing ground, and his dismay was keen, for a wonderful thing had come into his life and he spent much of his time in delicious contemplative day dreams concerning it, waiting for the hour when he would dare translate those dreams into realities. It seemed to him that he had always loved Norine; certainly she had enraptured herself in his heart long before his mind had regained its clarity, for he had come out of his delicious wanderings with his love full grown.

The time came finally when he could no longer permit the girl to deceive herself or him with her brave assumption of cheerfulness. Norine had just told him that he was doing famously, but he smiled and shook his weary head.

"Let's be honest," he said. "You know and I know that I can't get well."

"You mustn't be discouraged," she told him, earnestly. "Remember this is a trying climate and we have nothing to do with. Even the food is wretched. I'm going to take you away."

Esteban stroked her hand softly. "You can't do that, Miss Evans. You have been wonderful to me and I can't begin to express my gratitude." Norine stirred, but he retained his grasp of her fingers, gaining courage from the contact to proceed. "I have been trying for a long time to tell you something. Will you listen?"

"Not now," she exclaimed, with a visible lessening of color. "Don't bother to tell me now."

"I've waited too long; I must speak. You have stayed on here just to nurse me. Isn't that true?"

"Now, then, you must stop thinking about me and make your arrangements to go home."

"There was a moment of silence. "Yes. You see, I know how tired you are of this misery, this poverty, this hopeless struggle. You're not a Cuban and our cause isn't yours. Expeditions come from the United States every now



"Esteban, dear, I'll never, never leave you!"

and then the government will see that you are put safely aboard the first ship that returns. I'll manage to get well somehow."

Norine's color had returned. She stood over the hammock, looking down mistily. "Don't you need me, want me any more?" she inquired.

Esteban turned his tired eyes away, fearing to betray in them his utter wretchedness. "You have done all there is to do. I want you to go back into your own world and forget."

A sudden impulse seized the girl. She stopped and gathered the sick man into her young, strong arms. "Don't be silly," she cried. "My world is your world, Esteban dear. I'll never, never leave you."

"Miss Evans! Norine!" Varona tried feebly to free himself. "You mustn't—"

Norine drew him closer. "You're going to tell me that you have nothing, can offer me nothing. You're going to do the generous, noble thing. Well! I hate generous people. I'm selfish, utterly selfish and spoiled, and I don't propose to be robbed of anything I want, least of all my happiness. You do love me, don't you?"

Esteban's cry was eloquent; he clasped his arms about her and she held him fiercely to her breast.

"We're quite mad, quite insane," he told her after a while. "This only makes it harder to give you up."

"You're not going to give me up and you're not going to die. I shan't let you. Think what you have to live for."

"I did wrong to surrender."

"It was I who surrendered. Come!

Must I say it all? Aren't you going to ask me—"

"What?"

"Why, to marry you, of course. We're going to be married, and I'm going to take you out of this miserable place."

"What happiness!" he murmured. "If I were well— But I won't let you marry a dying man."

Norine rose, her face aglow with new strength, new determination. "I brought you back when you were all but gone. I saved you after the others had given you up, and now you are mine to do with as I please. You belong to me and I shan't consult you."

She turned, for a figure had darkened the door; it was one of her English-speaking convalescents who was acting as a sort of orderly.

"Senorita," the man said, with a flash of white teeth, "we have another sick man, and you'd never guess who. It is that American, El Demonio—"

"Is he sick or wounded?" Esteban inquired.

"Shot by a Spanish bullet. He asked at once for our senorita."

"Of course. I'll come in an instant." When the messenger had gone Norine bent and pressed her lips to Esteban's. "Remember, you're mine to do with as I please," she said; then she fled down the grassy street.

Branch was waiting at Norine's quarters, a soiled figure of dejection. His left arm lay in a sling across his breast. He looked up at her approach, but she scarcely recognized him, so greatly changed was he.

"Hello, Norine!" he cried. "Well, they got me."

Norine paused in astonishment. "Why, Leslie! I was so frightened! But—you can't be badly hurt."

"Bad enough so that Lopez sent me in. A fellow gets flyblown if he stays in the field, so I beat it."

"Has your arm been dressed?"

"No. I wouldn't let these rough-and-tumble doctors touch it. They'd amputate at the shoulder for a hangnail. I don't trust 'em."

"Then I'll look at it."

"It doesn't hurt, really," he declared. "It's only a scratch."

"Then behave yourself." Norine forced the patient into a chair and withdrew his arm from the sling.

Then, despite his weak resistance, she deftly removed the bandage. From his expression she felt sure that she must be hurting him, but when the injury was exposed she looked up in wonderment.

"Leslie!" she exclaimed. "What in the world—"

Branch struggled with himself, he swallowed hard, then said: "You can see now why I didn't go to a doctor; I did it—shot myself. You won't give me away?"

Norine seated herself weakly; she stared in bewilderment at the unhappy speaker. "Afraid? You, El Demonio! Why, you aren't afraid of anything!"

"Say! You don't believe all that stuff, do you? I'm afraid of my shadow and always have been. I'm not brave and never was. They told me I was going to die and it scared me so that I tried to end things quickly. I couldn't bear to die slowly, to know that I was dying by inches. But, Lord! it scared me even worse to go into battle. I was blind with fright all the time and I never got over it. Why, the sight of a gun gives me a chill, and I jump every time one goes off. Lord! how I've suffered! I went crazy at our first engagement—crazy with fear. I didn't know where I was, or what happened, or anything. Afterward, when they hailed me as a hero, I thought they were kidding, that everybody must know how frightened I was. After a time I saw that I'd fooled them, and that shamed me. Then—I had to keep it up or become ridiculous. But it nearly killed me."

It so happened that the president and well-nigh the entire provisional cabinet were in Cubitas. Leslie and Norine went directly to the former. He promptly sent for the minister of justice, who in turn gallantly put himself at Norine's disposal. In no time the news had spread and there was subdued excitement throughout the camp. Norine was between tears and laughter when she ran panting into Esteban's cabin, leaving Branch to wait outside.

At sight of her Esteban uttered a low cry of happiness. "Dearest! I've been lying in a stupor of delight. The world has become bright. I hear people laughing. What a change!"

"I've arranged everything! The president and his cabinet are coming to witness the ceremony."

Esteban poised upon his elbow, his face was a study. "What have you arranged?" he managed to inquire.

"Sh-h!" Norine laid a finger upon his lips. "The guest of the republic is to be married today."

"Norine! Oh, my dear—" quavered the sick man. "I can't let you do such a mad thing. Think! I'm ready for the grave—"

"This will make you well. We're going away when the very next expedition arrives."

"I haven't the strength to refuse," Esteban murmured. "And yet, how can I leave Cuba? What right have I to accept happiness and leave Rosa—"

This was a subject which Norine dreaded, a question to which she knew no answer. She was not in a mood to discuss it, and made no attempt to do so. Instead, she laid the invalid upon his pillow, saying:

"Leslie is waiting to wish you joy and a quick recovery. May I ask him in?"

She stepped to the door, only to behold her late companion making off down the village street in great haste and evident excitement. Approaching between the drunken rows of grass butts was a little knot of people. Even as Norine watched it grew into a considerable crowd, for men and women and children came hurrying from their tasks. There were three figures in the lead, a man and two boys, and they walked slowly, ploddingly, as if weary from a long march.

"Esteban!" Norine cried in a voice she scarcely recognized. She retreated into the doorway with one hand upon her leaping heart. "Esteban! Look! They're coming—here! Yes! It's—It's O'Reilly!"

Young Varona struggled from his hammock. "Rosa!" he called, loudly. "Rosa!"

There came a shadow, then in the doorway the figure of a man, a tattered scarecrow of a man whose feet were



It Was O'Reilly!

bare and whose brown calves were exposed through flapping pants. His breast was naked where thorns had tried to stay him; his beard, even his hair, were matted and unkempt, and the mud of many trails lay caked upon his garments.

It was O'Reilly! Dumb with amazement, blind with tears, Norine found herself staring upward into his face, and heard him saying:

"I told you I would bring her home." The next instant she lay upon his breast and sobbed of joy were tearing at her.

The story of Rosa's rescue came slowly and in fragments, for the news of O'Reilly's return caused a sensation. His recital was interrupted many times. "As a matter of fact, our getaway was ridiculously easy," he said, "for we had luck at every turn—regular Irish luck. I made Morin independent for life, but it wasn't the money, it was Jacket who induced him to bring us clear to Turiguanu. He landed us one night, this side of the Moron trocha. Since then we've waded swamps to our armpits, we've fought the jungle and chewed bark—but we're here." Johnnie heaved a deep sigh of relief.

"Where did you get the money to hire schooners and corrupt captains?" Branch inquired.

O'Reilly hesitated; he lowered his voice to a whisper. "We found the Varona treasure."

Norine uttered a cry. "Not Don Esteban's treasure?"

"Exactly. It was in the well where young Esteban told us it was."

Johnnie produced from his pocket a handful of coins.

Branch's eyes bulged, he touched a gold piece respectfully, weighed it carefully, then pressed it to his lips. He rubbed it against his cheeks and in his hair; he placed it between his teeth and bit it.

"It's real!" he cried. "Now let me look at the jewels."

"Rosa has them. She's wearing them on her back. Hunched backs are lucky, you know; hers is worth a fortune."

"Why, this beats the Arabian Nights!" Norine gasped.

"It beats—" Branch paused, then wagged his head warningly at the girl. "I don't believe a word of it and you mustn't."

Then Johnnie told the story. When he had finished there was a long moment of silence. Then Norine quavered tremulously: "That boy! That blessed boy!"

"It's all too weirdly improbable," O'Reilly smiled, "but ask Rosa or Jacket—the boy is bursting to tell some one. He nearly died because he couldn't brag about it to Captain Morin, and there won't be any holding him now. I'm afraid he'll tip off the news about that treasure in spite of all my warnings. Those jewels are a temptation; I won't rest easy until they're safely locked up in some good vault. Now then, I've told you every thing, but I'm dying for news. Tell me about yourselves, about Esteban. I expected to find him well. What alls him?"

"Oh, Johnnie!" Norine began. "He's very ill. He isn't getting well. Help me, Johnnie! Help me to get him home—"

"Of course I will. We'll take him and Rosa away where they can forget Cuba and all the misery it has caused them. We'll make him well—don't worry."

O'Reilly saw little of his sweetheart that day, for Norine promptly bore the girl off to her own quarters and there attended to her needs, the most pressing of which was clothing.

While O'Reilly was similarly engaged in making himself presentable, he and Branch talked earnestly, with the result that they repaired later to General Gomez. O'Reilly concluded by saying:

"I've done what I came to do, sir, but Miss Varona is badly shaken by all she has been through. She's very nervous and far from well. Esteban, too, isn't recovering."

General Gomez nodded. "Miss Evans declares he must have a change, and we have arranged to send him out of the country. His sister, poor child, should go, too."

"They should go at once," O'Reilly said, positively. "That's why we came to see you. Let us—Branch and me—take all three of them to the United States."

"But how? How can you take two women and a sick man—"

"We'll manage somehow," O'Reilly declared. "It isn't far across to the Bahama Banks. I'll agree to come back if you so desire."

Gomez shook his white head. "No! You came to find and save your fiancée, and you volunteered to serve with us while you were doing so. We have no desire to keep any man against his will. Some one must escort Miss Evans, who is our guest. Why not you two?"

"I was looking forward to an interesting ceremony this afternoon," Gomez

Poor Facilities

Because of inadequate facilities provided by the Southern Pacific railroad at Oregon City, receivers of merchandise are compelled to submit to unreasonable charges in securing freight delivered here in carload lots. One automobile agency reports that the cost of unloading a car of motor vehicles amounts to \$25, when a reasonable cost would not exceed \$10.

Oregon City has been for many years a patient sufferer on account of indifference to its actual needs. Our Southern Pacific station is no credit, either to the town or to the company, and one of the first things the company should do when the operation of its road is released from federal control January 1 next is to plan the early construction of a modern passenger station and provide conveniences for unloading freight cars.

As a shipping point of importance and as a growing community Oregon City is fairly entitled to ordinarily decent facilities to meet its transportation problems.

men went on. Was your ar... changed the plans?"

"Oh no, sir!" O'Reilly said, quickly. "I'd like to make it doubly interesting. If Miss Varona will consent to such short notice."

"Bravo! You have a way of doing the unexpected. Why not? I don't think Miss Varona will have it in her heart to refuse you anything."

The old soldier was right. Rosa did not gaily say her lover, and toward sundown the city among the leaves witnessed an unaccustomed scene.

Rosa, very dainty in her borrowed nurse's uniform, was round-eyed, timid; she evoked much admiration, but when she was addressed as Senora O'Reilly she blushed to the roots of her hair and shrank close to her husband's side. Branch proved to be a happy choice as Esteban's proxy, for he relieved Norine's anxiety and smothered her apprehensions.

When Rosa and O'Reilly returned to Esteban's cabin they found Norine ahead of them. She was kneeling beside the sick man's hammock, and through the doorway came the low, intimate murmur of their voices. Rosa drew her husband away, whispering, happily:

"He will get well, God and that wonderful girl won't let him die."

(Continued in next issue.)

ROADMASTER'S REPORT SHOWS MUCH PROGRESS

The outstanding feature of the work being done by the County Road crew is the announcement of the completion on Monday, Sept. 22 of the paving being done on the East Side river road in Gladstone. As soon as this particular stretch of pavement is set sufficiently to bear traffic it will be thrown open and traffic from Oregon City to Portland will be permitted to make use of the new link, which completes the hard surface pavement between the two cities.

The rock crusher located near Baker's bridge is at present engaged in the work of furnishing material for paving the road along the south side of the Clackamas river from Baker's Bridge connecting that point with the Clackamas Bottom road and this work will be completed in about two weeks.

Scarfing and smoothing up of several miles of roadway in the Molalla district was started several days ago and one of the big caterpillar tractors belonging to the county has been sent to that point to smooth up and roll the loose gravel and put the roads at that point in good shape before the fall rainy season.

The work of macadamizing the Logan road above Baker's bridge will be practically complete after two more weeks' work at that point.

Beginning Monday, Sept. 22, the crusher outfit near Sandy will begin operation to furnish material to repair a bad stretch of roadway about a half mile in length on the main highway to Mt. Hood which has caused a considerable amount of inconvenience to motorists during the past season. It is expected that this work will be completed in three or four weeks.

LIVE WIRES ARE UNANIMOUS FOR IMPROVEMENTS

Unanimous endorsement of the proposed bond issue of \$35,000 for the construction and equipment of a gymnasium and manual training building on the high school grounds; sanction of the proposed bond issue of \$17,000 for permanent roads in Clackamas county; setting aside next Tuesday's meeting for discussion of the housing problem, and protest over the failure of the city administration to police the city after 3 a. m. featured the initial luncheon of the Live Wires of the Commercial Club Tuesday.

R. W. Kirk, city school superintendent, and Luther A. King, director of physical training explained the need of a new building, and suggested that evening classes could probably be arranged for business men in the proposed gymnasium.

The lethargy of Oregon City property owners over the need for more dwellings was pointed out, and an effort will be made to renew interest in the plan submitted last spring to organize a company and building houses to be sold on an easy payment plan. It was explained that extensions of the garment factory operations of the woolen mill had been transferred to Portland, and 75 machines moved to that city, because of the inability of the concern to obtain labor here.

The Modern Bakery, recently established here, presented a huge cake to the Wiron, and it was formally presented by C. W. Robey, in behalf of the bakery.

STEEL STRIKES COST HUGE SUM DAILY IN WAGES AND EARNINGS

PITTSBURG, Sept. 24.—The steel strike is costing the iron and steel workers of the country approximately \$2,000,000 a day in wages alone. These figures are based upon the payrolls of the United States Steel company, which controls about 50 per cent of the steel output in the United States, and the independent concerns which control the balance.

It is estimated that the strike is costing the steel interests more than \$1,200,000 a day in earnings.

STRIKE OF STEEL MEN VARYING IN SUCCESS

PITTSBURG, Pa., Sept. 22.—The big steel strike broke quietly over the United States today. From the Rockies to the Alleghenies the big mills which form the nation's greatest industry continued operations with crippled forces, varying according to the locality and the degree of organization which the American Federation of Labor succeeded in effecting.

At noon, William Z. Foster, secretary of the national committee for organizing iron and steel workers, gave out the following figures as indicating the number of men on strike:

Chicago district 60,000; Cleveland 30,000; Youngstown 45,000; Buffalo 12,000; Homestead 9,000; Braddock 5,000; Rankin 3,000; Clairton 4,000; Monessen and Donora 12,000; Wheeling 15,000; Steubenville 6,000; Pueblo 6,000; McKeesport and Duquesne 12,000; Pittsburgh City 15,000; Vandergrift 4,000; Leechburg 2,000; Cranberry 5,000; Johnstown 15,000; Coatesville 4,000; total 284,000.

An important feature of the situation was the announcement by representatives of the 35,000 workers employed by the Bethlehem Steel company that these men would not join the strike pending an attempt to obtain a conference with the company officials.

SAWMILL COMPANY DEFENDANT IN SUIT FILED WITH CLERK

In a complaint filed with County Clerk Fred Miller Friday, T. H. Johnson has started action against the Victory Lumber Co. of Eagle Creek to recover moneys due him from the company for services performed for the company in the capacity of manager of the mill at Eagle Creek.

Mr. Johnson claims in his complaint that he is entitled to wages in the sum of \$925.10, \$75 for tools and supplies furnished by him for the company, and \$43.00 for money furnished by him at various times for the account of the company, making a total of \$770.10. Mr. Johnson asks the court to grant him a judgment in that amount with sufficient additional sums to cover the necessary attorney's fees in the trial of the court.

P. R. L. & P. ASKS 8 CENTS FARE ON ALL CAR LINES

PORTLAND, Sept. 22.—An 8 cent fare on the lines of the Portland Railway, Light & Power company was asked of the public service commission by Franklin T. Griffith, president of the company, in a statement opening the hearing on increased fares at the courthouse this morning.

He declares that run is in store for the company and that disruption of service is unavoidable if present railway fares are continued.

"It is to the interest of the public and railway service that the Portland Railway, Light and Power company be placed on a sound financial basis," Griffith told the commission. "It can be done only through an increase, and that increase must place fares at not less than eight cents."

ASIA MINOR HAS NEW GOVERNMENT

PARIS, Sept. 17.—Kiamil Pascha, former grand vizier of Turkey, has organized a nationalist government in Asia Minor at Erzurum, and convoked a national assembly at Sivas.

Prince Feisal, son of the king of the Hedjaz, left Malta yesterday on the way to Marseilles.

FRENCH CELEBRATE ANNIVERSARY DATE OF ST. MIHIEL VICTORY

ST. MIHIEL, via Paris, Sept. 24.—American soldiers were pouring through St. Mihiel a year ago in thousands, going to and from the new front their smashing victory had established.

Today Brigadier General Hart, his sergeant chauffeur, 16 Catholic war council workers and the Tribune correspondent were the only Americans to witness the fête of the first anniversary of liberation.

The principal ceremonies included mass for the fallen, laying the first stone for President Poincaré, dedication of a Franco-American monument of the military ceremony and inauguration of an osanary for the unknown dead.

EXTENT OF STEELMEN'S STRIKE IS UNCERTAIN

WASHINGTON, Sept. 23.—The second day of the great struggle between the labor unions of the United States Steel corporation opened with the question as to the extent to which the industry has been affected by the strike still uncertain, confused as it is by the conflicting claims of the leaders on each side. That the industry has been gravely crippled in the great centers of Pittsburgh, Chicago and Youngstown was certain and early reports today recorded several gains for the strikers.

WASHINGTON, Sept. 23.—Investigation of the steel strike by the senate labor committee was ordered today by the senate. A resolution by Senator Kenyon, republican, Iowa, providing for the inquiry and authorizing a report as to whether remedial federal action could be taken, was adopted without a roll call.

Senator Kenyon said it was proposed to call the leaders representing both employers and employees to Washington in an effort to determine the cause of the strike.

Senator Kenyon announced later that the investigation would be begun Thursday and that the first witness would be Chairman Gary of the United States Steel corporation, and John J. Fitzpatrick, chairman of the national committee organizing the steel workers.

FORMER WINNER OF PENDLETON ROUND-UP IS SHOT IN QUARREL

PENDLETON, Sept. 19.—John Spain, 1912 Round-Up champion, was shot through the side and arm last night in a local hotel by Charles Burton, said to be from LaGrande, Spain and "Jane Doe," said to be Burton's wife, each forfeited \$50 in police court this morning, charged with violating the immoral practices act. Police are holding Burton, while Spain is in the hospital. He will recover.

SALMON RUN IN SANDY REPORTED ON; FISHING EXCELLENT IS SAID

PORTLAND, Sept. 19.—Salmon have started on their fall run up the Columbia river and have already reached the Sandy river, according to reports received in office of the state fish and game commission here. The report states that the fish are running up the Sandy in great numbers and are being followed by large numbers of sea trout.

Good catches of the sea trout have already been reported besides several fair sized catches of good sized salmon. A few spring chinook or pink salmon are also reported as having been seen during the past few days.

CARELESSNESS OF DOCTOR BASIS FOR \$10,000 DAMAGE SUIT

In a complaint filed with County Clerk Fred Miller, Lena Lehman started action against Dr. George C. Knott for the recovery of damages in the sum of \$10,000 as a result of permanent injuries she claims to have sustained when Dr. Knott attended her for a fractured arm and wrist. The accident resulting in the fracture occurred in November 1918, and Mrs. Lehman states in her complaint that after being attended and discharged by Dr. Knott as healed she discovered that the bones had never been properly placed to knit and that as a result her arm and hand are permanently disfigured and disabled.

EVACUATION OF NORTH RUSSIA BEGUN BY BRITISH.

LONDON, Sept. 19.—Evacuation of Northern Russia is proceeding, although there is insufficient shipping to carry the troops and the war supplies, said a dispatch from Archangel today. Many of the ships are crowded with civilian refugees who fear to remain behind after the troops leave.

A man's hair, it is estimated, turns gray five years earlier than a woman's.

STREET RAILWAYS OF PORTLAND MAY BE MUNICIPAL OPERATED

PORTLAND, Sept. 24.—To study in its entirety the municipal railway problem and draw up a service at cost franchise for the Portland Railway, Light & Power company from the Newell or other plans, a committee of five representatives of the public, corporation and employees will be appointed Monday, resulting from a meeting of representatives of the city council, public service commission, railway company and employees at the courthouse Tuesday afternoon to discuss the plan formulated by J. P. Newell.

All phases of the subject are to be thoroughly delved into by the commission, and a franchise will be drawn for ratification by the people of Portland.

A new era for municipal railways looms large as a result of the meeting Tuesday, an era in which the public is to be seriously considered as the leading factor in operation and organization of the railway, and in which the bondholders are to be secured in their investment by the public, and in which employees will be added to a share in the earnings of the company.

TWO-BIT AD BRINGS QUICK RESULTS IN MORNING ENTERPRISE